



# MIDI Bridge - dLive

## Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

A menu bar app keeping a permanent two-way link between your DAW and the dLive: it creates the “dLive Bridge” virtual MIDI ports and shuttles everything to the console over the network (MIDI over TCP).

### Menu bar disc

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Click       | Show / hide the control panel.                                                                                                                                                          |
| Right-click | Show MIDI Monitor, Reload MIDI Monitor, or Quit (Quit is also in the panel footer).                                                                                                     |
| Disc colour | Grey outline = stopped · Red = no connection · Amber, breathing = connecting · Green = connected · Cyan flash = MIDI flowing · Amber ! = error (click the status tile to open the log). |

### First-run setup

|                   |                                                                                                    |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Console IP / Port | The MixRack’s address. Port defaults to 51325 (dLive MIDI over TCP).                               |
| Base MIDI Channel | Must match Utility → Control → MIDI on the console.                                                |
| Your DAW          | Restart your DAW after the bridge’s first start so “dLive Bridge” appears in its MIDI output list. |

### Options

|                   |                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Auto-reconnect    | On: after a drop the bridge retries hard for 30 s, then every 30 s. Off: it stays red until you click Restart Bridge. |
| Verbose logging   | Writes every MIDI message with raw bytes to the log. Debugging only — the log grows quickly.                          |
| Start at login    | Launches the bridge with the Mac (default on).                                                                        |
| Option key (held) | Reveals “Edit config file...” for advanced settings.                                                                  |

### MIDI monitor

|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Panel peek               | The last 5 MIDI events, live, under MIDI ACTIVITY.                                                                                                                                                                |
| Show MIDI Monitor...     | The full stream: filter by direction, type or source, search, pause, click a row for raw bytes. Open it from the panel, or by right-clicking the menu bar disc.                                                   |
| Finding the window again | While the monitor is open the app appears in the Dock and in Cmd-Tab, and the window is listed in the Window menu. It follows you to whichever desktop Space you are on, and keeps its log when you reopen it.    |
| Source labels            | Every row is tagged with where it came from — your DAW, the console’s surface, the bridge’s own housekeeping, or a connected app by name (e.g. “Pilot Tone Trigger”). Use the source menu to watch one at a time. |
| Actions                  | Outgoing Control Changes on the base channel are shown as probable console Actions. Which Action a CC triggers is bound on the console, so the bridge flags the intent, not the name.                             |
| Simple / Advanced view   | The monitor hides low-level protocol scaffolding by default; switch to <b>Advanced</b> to see everything on the wire — fader pings, heartbeat probes, NRPN address messages — for deep debugging.                 |
| The two dots             | “bridge” = link to the bridge app; “console” = the bridge’s link to the desk — only the second means you reach the console.                                                                                       |



## Sharing the console

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>One link, many apps</b> | Other software can reach the desk through the bridge instead of opening its own connection to the console. Talk Light Trigger, Pilot Tone Trigger and Console Control do this automatically when pointed at the “dLive Bridge” port, and Bitfocus Companion can connect to the bridge too. |
| <b>Why it helps</b>        | One link to the console instead of several, and each app’s traffic is labelled by name in the monitor, so you can see exactly what sent what.                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>dLive Bridge Return</b> | Console activity is passed back to your DAW on this second port. The bridge’s own background housekeeping is not, so it no longer clutters what your DAW receives.                                                                                                                         |

## Running it

|                               |                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Start / Stop / Restart</b> | Controls the bridge process. After changing a connection setting, click Restart Bridge to apply it. |
| <b>Status tile</b>            | Mirrors the menu bar disc, plus host, last activity and msg/s.                                      |

**Important — if the bridge sits at “Connecting...” while the desk is reachable, another controller may be holding the console’s MIDI-over-TCP port. Quit the A&H MIDI Driver (or other control software) and click Restart Bridge.**

## Log files

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Where they live</b>  | All in <code>~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/MIDI Bridge/</code> , the folder every dylanmaudio app logs to — in Finder, hold Option, open the Go menu and choose Library, then Logs. Or skip the folder: <b>Export log</b> in the panel footer drops a copy on your Desktop. |
| <b>dlive-bridge.log</b> | What the bridge is doing: connections, reconnects, errors. This is the one “Open Log” shows you, and the one to send if something goes wrong.                                                                                                                            |
| <b>dlive-midi.jsonl</b> | Every MIDI message, one line each, for detailed diagnosis. <b>Off by default</b> — turn on <b>midi_log</b> in the config file (hold Option in the panel to reveal “Edit config file...”). It grows quickly.                                                              |
| <b>Managing it</b>      | The MIDI Monitor’s footer shows its size, with <b>Save a copy</b> and <b>Clear log file</b> beside it — no need to go looking for the file. A saved copy lands in the same folder, stamped with the date and time.                                                       |
| <b>Rotation</b>         | The MIDI log renames itself to <b>.jsonl.1</b> at 100 MB and starts fresh, and any previous <b>.jsonl.1</b> is discarded at that point. Save a copy first if you need to keep a capture.                                                                                 |



## What's new in v1.1.7

- New: every session now writes a log, and a new Export log button in the footer saves a copy to your Desktop — so if something goes wrong at a show, there is evidence to send, without instructions.
- Fixed: moving a fader on the console could send the CPU and the MIDI log through the roof — one show machine wrote about 100 MB of log a minute. The bridge was asking the console "what level is that now?" in response to the console's own answer, which prompted it to ask again, and so on — around 2,200 questions a second. It no longer asks at all: the console already broadcasts the level with every move, so the answer was in front of it the whole time. The behaviour has been removed rather than switched off, since the console broadcasts the level either way; software that needs a value the console has not sent can still ask for it directly.
- The bridge's picture of the console is now built purely from what the console broadcasts. It is accurate the moment you connect, it updates from anyone's changes — the desk surface, Companion, another app — and it never has to interrogate the console to stay right.
- Fixed: a channel could show a level it was never set to. When two programs talk to the console at once, the desk passes along fragments of each one's messages, and the bridge could stitch a fragment onto an older, unrelated message and invent a change that never happened. It now trusts only a complete, uninterrupted instruction.
- New: if the bridge is set to the wrong MIDI base channel, it now says so — and names the channel the console is actually using. Previously this was indistinguishable from a dead console: nothing decoded, nothing was answered, and the bridge reconnected every 45 seconds forever against a desk that was working perfectly.
- The bridge now notices a console that has stopped answering within a couple of seconds rather than 45, having measured how fast a healthy desk actually replies.